“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 4

An Account of the Root Purpose of Caitanya’s Descent

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 By the grace of Śrī Caitanya even a child, looking into the scriptures, can ascertain the true form of Him who sports in Vraja.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have explained the meaning of the fourth verse. Now hear with attention the meaning of the fifth.

4 To bring out the meaning of the root verse, I shall first give an outline before applying it.

5 The essence of the fourth verse, as I have explained it, is this: the Lord descended to spread divine love and the holy name.

6 This reason is true, but it is external. There is another reason, an inner one — hear it.[2]

7 The scriptures proclaim that in the past Kṛṣṇa descended to remove the burden of the earth.[3]

8 But removing the burden is not the work of Bhagavān Himself. It is Viṣṇu, the maintainer, who protects the world.[4]

9 Yet the time of Kṛṣṇa's descent coincided with the time for removing that burden.

10 When the complete Bhagavān descends, all the other avatāras come and meet in Him.

11–12 Nārāyaṇa, the Catur-vyūha, Matsya and the other avatāras, the avatāras of the yugas and the manvantaras, and as many others as there are — all come and descend within the body of Kṛṣṇa. So does Kṛṣṇa, the complete Bhagavān, descend.[5]

13 Therefore Viṣṇu was then within the body of Kṛṣṇa, and through Viṣṇu Kṛṣṇa slew the demons.

14 The killing of the demons is a secondary work. Now I shall tell the root cause for which He descends.

15–16 To taste the very essence of the rasa of love, and to spread in the world devotion on the path of rāga (*rāga-mārga*) — for these two reasons the desire to descend arose in Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all who relish rasa, the supremely merciful.[6]

17 The whole world is permeated by the awareness of My majesty, and love slackened by awe gives Me no joy.[7]

18 One who regards Me as the Lord and himself as lowly — by his love I am not subdued; I do not become dependent on him.

19 In whatever mood a devotee worships Me, in that very mood I reciprocate with him. Such is My nature.

20 "As people surrender to Me, so do I reward them. O Pārtha, all men follow My path in every way." (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.11)[8]

21–22 Whoever renders Me pure devotion in the mood "He is my son, my friend, the lord of my life", considering himself great and Me equal or lower — in that mood I become subject to him.[9]

23 "Devotion to Me brings living beings to immortality. And how fortunate you are to have the love that brings you to Me!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.44)[10]

24 My mother binds Me in the mood of a son; thinking Me utterly helpless, she fondles and cares for Me.

25 My friend, in pure friendship, climbs on My shoulders and says, "What great man are You? You and I are equal!"

26 When My beloved, in her pique (*māna*), rebukes Me, her reproaches steal My heart more than the hymns of the Vedas.[11]

27–28 Taking this pure devotion with Me, I shall descend and perform many kinds of wondrous pastimes, such as are not shown even in Vaikuṇṭha — pastimes that astonish even Me.[12]

29 By her own power Yogamāyā will awaken in the gopīs a love for Me as a lover who is not their husband (*upapati*).[13]

30 Neither I nor the gopīs will know of it, for each of us will ever steal the other's heart with beauty and virtues.[14]

31 Leaving dharma behind, the two will meet in love (*rāga*) — sometimes meeting, sometimes not, as destiny arranges.

32 I shall taste the essence of all these rasas, and by this means I shall show grace to all My devotees.

33 Hearing of the pure love (*rāga*) of Vraja, the devotees will worship Me on the path of rāga, leaving aside their religious duties (*dharma-karma*).[15]

34 "To show favour to His devotees, Kṛṣṇa takes a body like a human one and performs such pastimes that whoever hears of them must become wholly devoted to Him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.36)[16]

35 The verb *bhavet* is in the injunctive mood (*vidhi-liṅ*), and so it says here: this is certainly a duty, and to neglect it is a fault.[17]

36–37 As this desire was the cause of Kṛṣṇa's appearance and the slaying of the demons only a secondary purpose, so too Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is the complete Bhagavān, and to inaugurate the religion of the age (*yuga-dharma*) is not His own desire.[18]

38 When for some reason He resolved to descend, the time of the *yuga-dharma* coincided with it.[19]

39 Descending for these two reasons, together with His devotees He Himself tastes prema and the congregational chanting of the name.

40 By this means He spread kīrtana even among the outcastes; weaving a garland of the holy name and divine love, He placed it around the whole world.

41 Thus, accepting the mood of a devotee, He preached devotion by practising it Himself.[20]

42 Servitude, friendship, parental love and the love of the beloved (*śṛṅgāra*) — these are the four kinds of prema, and the four kinds of devotees are their vessels.[21]

43 Each considers his own mood the best, and in that mood he tastes happiness with Kṛṣṇa.

44 But if one considers it in one's heart without partiality, the sweetness of *śṛṅgāra* surpasses that of all the other rasas.[22]

45 "Although love (*rati*), rising from one kind to the next, is ever richer in delight, by the inclination of the heart one particular kind seems sweetest to a particular devotee." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.38)[23]

46 Therefore I call it *madhura-rasa*, the sweet rasa. It exists in two forms: *svakīyā*, conjugal love, and *parakīyā*, love not bound by marriage.[24]

47 In *parakīyā* rasa rises to its highest delight, and nowhere but in Vraja does it dwell.[25]

48 In the young women of Vraja this mood is boundless, and among them it reaches its summit in Śrī Rādhā.[26]

49 Her love, mature and pure in feeling, is the highest of all; it is through this love that the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa is tasted in its fullness.[27]

50 Therefore Śrī Hari, appearing as Gaurāṅga, accepted that mood and fulfilled His own desire.[28]

51 “He is the refuge hard to reach even for the lords of the gods, the supreme goal of the Upaniṣads, the all-in-all of the sages, the sweetness of the hosts who bow to Him, and the very essence of the love of the lotus-eyed cowherd girls of Vraja. Will that Caitanya ever again come before my eyes?” (Stava-mālā, the first Caitanyāṣṭaka, 2)[29]

52 “Eager for delight, the Lord stole from one among the host of His beloveds (Śrī Rādhā) Her boundless wealth of rasa, indescribably sweet, that He might relish it Himself. For this He covered His own lustre and revealed here Her radiance. May He, in the form of Caitanya, be boundlessly merciful to us!” (Stava-mālā, the second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 3)[30]

53 It was to accept that mood that He established dharma. Now I shall tell its chief reason — listen, everyone.[31]

54 Up to now I have given an outline of the verse to point to the root reason. Now I shall reveal the meaning of that verse.

55 “Śrī Rādhā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa’s love, His pleasure potency, *hlādinī-śakti*. Therefore, though Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Self, from time without beginning They have appeared in the world in two different forms. Now these Two have become one and are manifest as Śrī Caitanya. I bow to Him, Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with the sentiment and the lustre of Śrī Rādhā.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[32]

56 Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one Self; assuming two bodies, They sport with each other, tasting rasa.[33]

57 Now those Two are one — Caitanya Gosāñi; to taste that mood (*bhāva*), They have come together in one form.[34]

58 For this reason I shall first describe that truth, for from it comes the telling of Gaura's glory.[35]

59 Rādhikā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa's love; She is the potency of His own nature (*svarūpa-śakti*) whose name is Hlādinī.[36]

60 Hlādinī makes Kṛṣṇa taste bliss, and through Hlādinī He nourishes His devotees.[37]

61 Kṛṣṇa's nature is eternity, knowledge and bliss; He is complete. And His one spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) takes three forms:[38]

62 In the aspect of bliss She is Hlādinī, in the aspect of being Sandhinī, and in the aspect of consciousness Samvit, which we know as knowledge.[39]

63 "O Lord, You are the basis of all, and in You Hlādinī, Sandhinī and Samvit are one potency. But that which causes joy, pain and a mixture of the two is not in You, for You are beyond the guṇas." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 1.12.69)[40]

64 The essential part of Sandhinī is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure being; in it the existence of Bhagavān rests.[41]

65 His mother and father, His abode, His house, His bed and seat and all else — all these are transformations of Kṛṣṇa's *śuddha-sattva*, pure transcendental being.[42]

66 "Pure being (*viśuddha-sattva*) is called *vasudeva*, for in it the Supreme Person is revealed unveiled. And in that being I worship with my mind Lord Vāsudeva, who is beyond the senses (Adhokṣaja)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 4.3.23)[43]

67 The knowledge that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān is the essence of Samvit; the knowledge of Brahman and all the rest are only its retinue.[44]

68 The essence of Hlādinī is prema, divine love; the essence of prema is *bhāva*; and the highest limit of *bhāva* is called *mahābhāva*.[45]

69 Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*. She is a mine of all virtues and the crest-jewel of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds.[46]

70 "Of the two, Rādhikā is superior in every way. She is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*, and in virtues She surpasses all." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, the chapter on Śrī Rādhā, 2)[47]

71 Her mind, senses and body are steeped in love for Kṛṣṇa; Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa's own potency, the helper in His play.[48]

72 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, the Soul of all. He dwells eternally in Goloka with the gopīs, His potencies (*kalās*), who are one with Him in nature and imbued with blissful spiritual rasa." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.37)[49]

73 Now hear how She makes Kṛṣṇa taste rasa and how She helps Him in His play.

74–75 Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are of three kinds: the Lakṣmīs, the queens in His city, and the girls of Vraja, the essence of them all. All of them expand from Śrī Rādhikā.[50]

76 As Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, manifests the avatāras, so the three groups expand from Rādhā, the source of all parts.[51]

77 The Lakṣmīs are, as it were, the splendour of Her body, and the queens are Her reflections (*bimba-pratibimba*).[52]

78 The Lakṣmīs are partial manifestations (*aṁśas*) of Her *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśas*.[53]

79 The goddesses of Vraja, differing in form and nature, are expansions of Her own body (*kāya-vyūha*), for the sake of rasa.[54]

80 Without many beloveds rasa does not rejoice; therefore, to help in the play, She has many manifestations.[55]

81 Among them the girls of Vraja, differing in moods and rasas, make Kṛṣṇa taste the rāsa dance and His other pastimes.[56]

82 Rādhā is the delight of Govinda and the enchantress of Govinda; She is Govinda's all-in-all and the crest-jewel of all His beloveds.[57]

83 "The goddess (*devī*) Rādhikā is declared to be full of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-mayī*). She is the supreme deity; all the Lakṣmīs are within Her; She is the whole of splendour (*sarva-kānti*) and the supreme enchantress." (Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra)[58]

84 *Devī* means "shining and supremely beautiful", or else "the city where Kṛṣṇa's worship and play abide".[59]

85 *Kṛṣṇa-mayī* — Kṛṣṇa is within Her and without; wherever Her eyes fall, there Kṛṣṇa appears.[60]

86 Or else: Kṛṣṇa's very nature is full of the rasa of love, and His potency is one with Him.[61]

87 Her worship of Kṛṣṇa consists in fulfilling His desires; therefore the Purāṇas explain Her name as Rādhikā.[62]

88 "Surely the Lord, Bhagavān Hari, has been worshipped by Her, for Govinda, pleased, has left us and led Her away to a secluded place." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.28)[63]

89 Therefore She is worshipped by all; She is the supreme deity, the protectress of all and the mother of the whole world.[64]

90 I have already explained the word *sarva-lakṣmī*: She is the abode of all the Lakṣmīs.[65]

91 Or *sarva-lakṣmī* means Kṛṣṇa's six kinds of opulence, and She is the potency that presides over them, the best of all His potencies.[66]

92 In Her dwells the splendour of all beauty, and from Her comes the beauty of all the Lakṣmīs.

93 Or the word *kānti* may mean all of Kṛṣṇa's desires, and all of them abide in Rādhā alone.[67]

94 Rādhikā fulfils whatever Kṛṣṇa desires. This is the meaning of the word *sarva-kānti*.

95 Kṛṣṇa enchants the world, and She enchants Him; therefore She is the supreme Mistress of all.[68]

96 Rādhā is the full potency, and Kṛṣṇa the full possessor of potency. The scriptures bear witness that there is no difference between the two.[69]

97 As musk and its fragrance are inseparable, as fire and its heat are never different,[70]

98 so Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are always one essence; to taste the rasa of Their pastimes They assume two forms.[71]

99–100 To teach loving devotion, He Himself descended, accepting both the mood and the lustre of Rādhā, and appeared in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. This is the explanation of the meaning of the fifth verse.[72]

101 To bring out the meaning of the sixth verse, I shall first give an outline of it.[73]

102 The Lord descended and preached saṅkīrtana; but that, as I have indicated before, is an external reason.[74]

103 There is another, chief seed of the descent: it is the very own work of Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all who relish rasa.[75]

104 That most hidden reason is threefold, and it was made known by Svarūpa Dāmodara.[76]

105 Svarūpa Gosāñi is the Lord's most intimate associate, and so he knows all these matters of the Lord.[77]

106 The Lord's heart is the very embodiment of Rādhikā's mood, and in that mood joy and sorrow arise in Him incessantly.[78]

107 In His last pastimes the Lord was mad with separation from Kṛṣṇa: all His actions were bewildered, and He spoke always as in delirium.[79]

108 As Rādhikā felt on seeing Uddhava, so the Lord remained, intoxicated with that mood, day and night.[80]

109 At night, holding Svarūpa by the neck, He spoke in delirium, and in His absorption He laid bare His own feelings.[81]

110 Whatever mood arose in the Lord's heart, Dāmodara gave Him joy with a song or a verse that suited it.

111 There is no need to consider all this now; later I shall describe it in detail.[82]

112 Formerly in Vraja Kṛṣṇa had three ages — childhood, boyhood and youth — and youth was the most essential of them.[83]

113 In the absorption of parental love He made His childhood fruitful, and with the host of His friends He made His boyhood fruitful.

114 And with Rādhikā and the other gopīs He performed the rāsa dance and other pastimes, and tasted the very essence of rasa to His heart's content.[84]

115 By the rāsa dance and other pastimes He made three things fruitful: His youth, Kāma (the god of love), and the whole world.[85]

116 "Honouring His youth, Madhusūdana, the destroyer of all that is inauspicious, sported on autumn nights amid a host of jewel-like girls." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 5.13.59)[86]

117 "By words that hinted boldly at the arts of love of the night before, He made Rādhikā close Her eyes in shyness before Her friends; then, drawing playful *makarīs* on Her breasts, He showed the utmost skill. So Hari, sport-

ing in the bowers, makes His youth fruitful." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.231)[87]

118 "O sweet-eyed one, had this Hari and Rādhikā not descended in Mathurā, all creation would have been in vain — and above all the god of love." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 7.3)[88]

119–120 Thus formerly Kṛṣṇa, the abode of rasa, relished the very essence of rasa; yet three of His desires remained unfulfilled, though He tried to taste them.[89]

121 I shall explain His first desire. Kṛṣṇa says: "I am the source of rasa.[90]

122 I am full of complete bliss, the spiritual and complete Truth; yet the love of Rādhikā makes Me mad.[91]

123 I do not know how much strength there is in Rādhā's love, by which She ever overwhelms Me.

124 Rādhikā is My teacher in love, and I am Her disciple, a dancer: She always makes Me dance new and unheard-of dances."

125 " 'Where have you come from, Vṛndā, dear friend?' 'From the feet of Hari.' 'And where is He?' 'In the forest by Rādhā-kuṇḍa.' 'What is He doing there?' 'Learning to dance.' 'And who is His teacher?' 'Your own image, Rādhā: appearing in every tree and creeper, in every quarter of the sky, it wanders all around like a skilled dancer and makes Kṛṣṇa dance behind it.' " (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.77)[92]

126 "The joy I feel in tasting My own love is great, but Rādhā's joy in tasting Her love is ten million times greater.[93]

127 As I am the shelter of mutually opposite qualities, so Rādhā's love is always full of opposite qualities.[94]

128 Rādhā's love is all-pervading, with no room left to grow; yet it grows at every moment.[95]

129 Nothing is greater than this love, and yet it is free of the pride that belongs to greatness.

130 Nothing is purer than this love, and yet its ways are ever contrary and crooked.

131 "All glory to Rādhikā's love for Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Mura! All-pervading, it grows at every moment; great, it is free of pride; again and again it grows more crooked, and yet it is pure." (Dāna-keli-kaumudī, 2)[96]

132 Rādhikā is the supreme *āśraya* of that love — the one in whom it dwells; and I am only its *viṣaya* — the One towards whom it flows.[97]

133 The happiness I taste is that of the *viṣaya*; the joy of the *āśraya* is ten million times greater than Mine.[98]

134 My mind runs after the happiness of the *āśraya*, but try as I may, I cannot taste it. What means can I find?[99]

135 If ever I become the *āśraya* of this love, then I shall know its bliss."

136 So Kṛṣṇa reflects, ever eager for wonder, and in His heart the longing for that love blazes ever higher.

137 That is one. Now hear of another kind of longing. Seeing His own sweetness, Kṛṣṇa reflects:[100]

138 “Wondrous, endless and complete is My sweetness; in the three worlds no one finds its limit.[101]

139 Through this love Rādhikā alone ever tastes all the nectar of My sweetness.

140 Though the mirror of Rādhā’s true love is spotless, its clearness grows at every moment.[102]

141 My sweetness has no room to grow, and yet before this mirror it shines in ever new forms.

142 My sweetness and Rādhā’s love vie with each other; at every moment both grow, and neither is defeated.[103]

143 My sweetness is ever new, and devotees taste it each according to his own love.

144 When I see My own sweetness in a mirror or the like, a longing to taste it arises, but I cannot taste it.

145 And when I consider how I might taste it, My mind runs to become Rādhikā Herself.”[104]

146 “What wondrous flood of My sweetness, never known before and surpassing all, appears here! Alas, seeing it, even I long with an eager heart to enjoy it, as Rādhikā does.” (Lalita-mādhava, 8.34)[105]

147 Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness has a natural power: it makes all men and women restless, beginning with Kṛṣṇa Himself.[106]

148 Heard of or seen, it draws every heart, and Kṛṣṇa Himself strives to taste it.

149 Whoever drinks this nectar of sweetness finds his thirst never quenched; the thirst only grows without end.[107]

150 Unsatisfied, he blames the Creator: “The unskilled Creator does not know how to create well!

151 He did not give me ten million eyes — he gave only two, and even those blink. How shall I see Kṛṣṇa?”

152 “At last, after long separation, the gopīs found their beloved Kṛṣṇa. Gazing at Him, they cursed the maker of their eyelids; then through their eyes they took Him into their hearts and embraced Him there to their fill. So they all attained a state that even perfected yogīs can hardly reach.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.39)[108]

153 “When by day You wander in the forest, a moment without You becomes an age for us. And as we gaze upon Your beautiful face framed in curling locks, we see what a fool was the maker of our eyelids.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.15)[109]

154 Without seeing Kṛṣṇa the eyes have no other fruit; whoever sees Kṛṣṇa is fortunate indeed.[110]

155 “O friends, we know no other fruit for the eyes than this: to drink in the faces of the two sons of Vraja’s lord as They drive the cows into the forest with Their friends, playing Their flutes and casting loving glances.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.7)[111]

156 “What austerities did the gopīs perform, that with their eyes they drink His form — the essence of loveliness, unequalled and unsurpassed, perfect in itself, new at every moment, hard to attain, the sole abode of fame, beauty and majesty?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.44.14)[112]

157 Unprecedented is Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness, and unprecedented its power: merely hearing of it, the mind trembles.

158 Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness awakens longing in Kṛṣṇa Himself; He cannot taste it fully, and sorrow remains in His heart.

159 So I have described the second reason. Now hear the nature of the third.[113]

160 This conclusion about rasa is most deeply hidden; Svarūpa Gosāñi alone knows it fully.[114]

161 If anyone else knows it, he knows it from him, for he is the very heart of Caitanya Gosāñi.

162 The love of the gopīs is called *rūḍha-bhāva*. It is pure and spotless prema, never lust (*kāma*).[115]

163 “It is the prema of the cowherd women that became famed under the name *kāma*; and so even Uddhava and others dear to the Lord long for it.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.285)[116]

164 Lust and love have different characteristics, as iron and gold differ in their very nature.[117]

165 The desire to please one’s own senses is called lust (*kāma*); the wish to please Kṛṣṇa’s senses bears the name of prema.[118]

166 The aim of lust is only one's own enjoyment; the aim of love is only Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and so love is mighty.[119]

167–169 Social custom and Vedic religion, the needs of the body and their duties, shame and restraint, bodily pleasure and the very core of their own happiness, the path of the noble (*ārya-patha*), so hard to give up, their own families, and all the chastisement and rebukes of their kin — giving up all this, they worship Kṛṣṇa and serve Him with love for His happiness alone.[120]

170 This is called firm attachment (*anurāga*) to Kṛṣṇa: it is as clean as washed cloth without a single stain.

171 Therefore there is a vast difference between lust and love: lust is blind darkness, and love the spotless sun.[121]

172 Therefore in the gopīs there is not even a trace of lust; their bond with Kṛṣṇa is for His happiness alone.[122]

173 "O dear one, Your tender lotus feet we place gently on our hard breasts, afraid to hurt them — and with those feet You wander through the forest! Are they not hurt by the sharp pebbles? You are our very life, and our minds are reeling." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.19)[123]

174 The gopīs give no thought to their own happiness or sorrow; all they do is for Kṛṣṇa's happiness.[124]

175 For Kṛṣṇa they have given up everything else, and their pure attachment is for His happiness alone.

176 "O tender ones! For My sake you have abandoned the laws of society and of the Vedas, and even your kinsmen. I disappeared only that your love

for Me might grow still stronger — yet even unseen I went on loving you. So, beloved ones, do not be displeased with Him who is dear to you." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.21)[125]

177 Kṛṣṇa has a promise from of old: as one worships Him, so does He reciprocate.[126]

178 "As people surrender to Me, so do I reward them. O Pārtha, all men follow My path in every way." (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.11)[127]

179 That promise was broken by the gopīs' worship, and the proof is in Kṛṣṇa's own words:[128]

180 "O gopīs, your union with Me is faultless. Even in a lifetime of the gods I could not repay you for what you have done: you cut the fetters of home, so hard to break, and came to Me. So let your own good deed be your reward." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.22)[129]

181 And if we see that the gopīs care for their own bodies, know for certain that this too is for Kṛṣṇa.[130]

182 "This body I have offered to Kṛṣṇa. It is His property, meant for His delight.

183 Seeing and touching this body gives Kṛṣṇa pleasure." For this reason they cleanse and adorn their bodies.

184 "O Pārtha, the gopīs tend even their own bodies, for they regard them as Mine. There is no greater vessel of My secret love than they." (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 40)[131]

185 There is another wondrous trait of the gopīs' love, whose power lies beyond the reach of the intellect.[132]

186 When the gopīs see Kṛṣṇa, they have no desire for happiness, and yet their happiness grows ten million times.

187 The joy Kṛṣṇa feels on seeing the gopīs — the gopīs taste ten million times more.

188 They have no concern for their own happiness, and still their happiness grows — here is a contradiction.

189 I see only one solution to this contradiction: the gopīs' happiness finds its fulfilment in Kṛṣṇa's happiness.[133]

190 On seeing the gopīs Kṛṣṇa's delight grows, and His sweetness, which has no equal, grows too.

191 "On seeing me Kṛṣṇa felt such happiness!" — with this happiness the gopīs' faces and bodies blossom.

192 The more Kṛṣṇa's beauty grows on seeing the gopīs' beauty, the more the gopīs' beauty grows on seeing His.

193 So a contest arises between them; both grow together, and neither turns away.

194 But Kṛṣṇa's happiness comes from the gopīs' beauty and virtues, and the gopīs' happiness grows by His happiness.[134]

195 Thus their happiness nourishes Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and for this reason there is no fault of lust in the gopīs' love.[135]

196 “I worship Keśava, returning victorious from the forest to Vraja. Rows of beautiful girls come out on the road to worship Him with hundreds of dancing side-glances mingled with budding smiles, and the corners of His eyes, like bees, wander over the flower-clusters of their breasts.” (Stava-mālā, Keśavāṣṭaka, 8)[136]

197 There is another natural sign of the gopīs’ love, which shows that it has no trace of lust.[137]

198 The gopīs’ love nourishes Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness, and that sweetness in turn makes their love grow, to their great delight.[138]

199 The bliss of the *āśraya* of love lies in the bliss of its *viṣaya*; there is no connection with the desire for one’s own happiness.[139]

200 Wherever love is unconditional, this is the law: the joy of the *āśraya* lies in the happiness of the *viṣaya*.[140]

201 If the bliss of one’s own love hinders the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa, the devotee is filled with great anger at that bliss.[141]

202 “Dāruka did not welcome the bliss of love that brought on a stupor of his body, for it put no small obstacle in the way of his fanning Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 3.2.62)[142]

203 “The lotus-eyed Rādhikā loudly condemned the bliss that poured floods of tears from Her eyes and kept Her from seeing Govinda.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.3.54)[143]

204 And pure devotees, without loving service to Kṛṣṇa, will not accept *sālokya* and the other liberations for their own happiness.[144]

205 “Merely by hearing of My qualities the mind flows unbroken towards Me, who dwell in all hearts, as the waters of the Gaṅgā flow into the ocean.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.11)[145]

206 “Such is the mark of bhakti-yoga beyond the guṇas (*nirguṇa*): devotion to the Supreme Person that is unmotivated and uninterrupted.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.12)[146]

207 “My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, nearness to Me, a form like Mine, or even oneness with Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)[147]

208 “Fulfilled by serving Me, My devotees do not desire even the four kinds of liberation — *sālokya*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and *sārṣṭi* — that such service brings them of itself. How then would they seek worldly pleasures, or merging in Brahman? For all that is swept away by time.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.67)[148]

209 The natural love of the gopīs is free of any trace of lust; it is spotless, radiant and pure, like molten gold.[149]

210 The gopīs are Kṛṣṇa’s helpers, teachers, friends and beloveds; they are His dear disciples, companions and servants.[150]

211 “Helpers, teachers, disciples, servants, friends and beloveds — truly I tell you, Pārtha, what are the gopīs not to Me?” (Ādi Purāṇa)[151]

212 The gopīs know the desires of Kṛṣṇa’s heart, the art of loving service, and all that their Beloved longs for.[152]

213 “O Pārtha, My greatness, My worship, what I long for and what My mind intends — these the gopīs know in truth; others do not.” (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 39)[153]

214 Among those gopīs the best is Rādhikā; in beauty, virtues, good fortune and love She surpasses all.[154]

215 “As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so is Her pond dear to Him; among all the gopīs She alone is His most beloved.” (Padma Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45)[155]

216 “O Pārtha, in the three worlds the earth is blessed, for there is the town of Vṛndāvana; and there the gopīs are blessed, for among them is she who is called Rādhā — My beloved.” (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 46)[156]

217 It is play with Rādhā that makes rasa grow; all the other gopīs only serve that rasa.[157]

218 Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa’s beloved, the treasure of His life; without Her the gopīs cannot be the cause of His happiness.[158]

219 “Placing Rādhā in His heart — the chain that bound His desire for the very essence of the rāsa — Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa, left the other beauties of Vraja.” (Gīta-govinda, 3.1)[159]

220 Taking that mood of Rādhā, Caitanya descended and preached the religion of the age — the holy name and divine love.[160]

221 In that mood He fulfilled His own desires; this desire was the root cause of His descent.

222 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi is the son of the king of Vraja — Kṛṣṇa, a form full of rasa, *śṛṅgāra* in person.[161]

223 He descended to taste that rasa, and along the way He spread all the rasas.[162]

224 "O friend, see how Hari sports in spring! Delighting all and giving them bliss, with limbs dark and tender as a row of blue lotuses He brings a festival to the god of love; freely embraced on every side by the beauties of Vraja, He is, as it were, *śṛṅgāra* embodied, enchanted Himself." (Gīta-govinda, 1.11)[163]

225 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi is the abode of rasa, and He tasted rasa in countless special ways.[164]

226 By this means He inaugurated the religion of the age of Kali. Caitanya's servants know the heart of all this.[165]

227–228 With devotion I hold on my head the feet of Advaita Ācārya, Nityānanda, Śrīnivāsa, Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Murāri, Haridāsa and all the other devotees of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa.[166]

229 So I have given an outline of the sixth verse. Now hear the meaning of the root verse; I shall reveal it.[167]

230 " 'What is the greatness of Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My own wondrous sweetness, which She alone tastes through that love? And what is the happiness She feels in experiencing Me?' Longing to know this, the moon Hari, rich with Her sentiment, was born from the ocean of Śacī's womb." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[168]

231 All these conclusions are hidden, and it is not fitting to speak them; yet if I do not speak, no one will find their end.[169]

232 So I shall speak a little, keeping the secret veiled: devotees who relish rasa will understand, and fools will not.

233 Whoever holds Caitanya and Nityānanda in his heart will find bliss in these conclusions.[170]

234 All these conclusions are like the young shoots of the mango tree, ever dear to the cuckoos — the devotees.[171]

235 The non-devotee camels cannot enter here, and so my heart feels a special joy.

236 If those for whom I fear to speak do not understand — what happiness in the three worlds is greater than this?[172]

237 Therefore, bowing to the devotees, I speak without fear; may they be filled with wonder.

238 Once Kṛṣṇa reflected within Himself: “All call Me the embodiment of complete bliss and rasa.[173]

239 The three worlds are gladdened by Me — but who is there to give joy to Me?

240 Only one whose virtues are hundreds upon hundreds of times greater than Mine could gladden My heart.

241 One greater than Me in virtues is impossible in the world — yet in Rādhā alone I find it.

242–243 Though My beauty surpasses ten million Cupids, though My sweetness is unequalled and unsurpassed, and though My form satisfies the three worlds — My eyes find their refreshment in seeing Rādhā.

244 The song of My flute attracts the three worlds, but My ears are captured by Rādhā's words.[174]

245 Though My fragrance perfumes the whole world, the scent of Rādhā's body steals My heart and My life.[175]

246 Though the world is made sweet by My rasa, the nectar of Rādhā's lips holds Me in its power.

247 Though My touch is cooler than ten million moons, Rādhikā's touch cools Me.

248 So I am the cause of the world's happiness, but Rādhikā's beauty and virtues are My very life.[176]

249 This is what I feel — but if I consider it, everything is the other way round.[177]

250 My eyes are refreshed by the sight of Rādhā, but at the sight of Me Rādhā swoons with happiness.

251 The flute-like sound of bamboos rubbing together steals Her senses, and, mistaking the *tamāla* tree for Me, She embraces it.[178]

252 "I have found Kṛṣṇa's embrace — my life is fulfilled!" Immersed in this happiness, She remains holding the tree in Her arms.[179]

253 If a favourable breeze brings Her My fragrance, She longs to fly to Me, blind with love.

254 When She tastes betel that I have chewed, She drowns in an ocean of bliss and knows nothing else.[180]

255 The bliss Rādhā finds in My company — even speaking with a hundred mouths I could not reach its end.

256 When Our pastimes end, Her body glows with the sweetness of happiness, and seeing it I forget Myself in joy.

257 Bharata Muni holds that the rasa of the two lovers is equal, but he does not know the rasa of My Vraja.[181]

258 Whatever happiness I find in the company of others, in Rādhā's company it is a hundred times greater.[182]

259 "O lovely one, Your bimba-red lips have a fragrance that surpasses the sweetness of nectar; Your face has the fragrance of the lotus; Your words put the cuckoo's song to shame; Your limbs are cool as sandal, and this body of Yours holds all the wealth of beauty. Having found You, O Rādhā, all My senses rejoice again and again." (Lalita-mādhava, 9.9)[183]

260 "Her eyes are greedy for the beauty of Kṛṣṇa, the slayer of Kaṁsa; Her skin thrills at His touch; Her ears are eager for His words, and Her nostrils delight in His fragrance; Her tongue longs for the nectar of His lips. She bows Her lotus face and pretends to great composure, yet even outwardly She is shaken by the surging transformations of love." (Rūpa Gosvāmī)[184]

261 From this I know that there is in Me some rasa that holds in its power Rādhā, My enchantress.[185]

262 I am ever eager to taste the kind of happiness Rādhā finds in Me.[186]

263 I make many efforts, but I cannot taste it; and the very scent of that sweet happiness makes the longing in My heart grow.

264 To taste rasa I have descended; I shall taste the rasa of love in all its kinds.[187]

265 And through the conduct of My pastimes I shall teach how devotees worship on the path of rāga.[188]

266 These three thirsts of Mine have not been quenched, for they cannot be tasted in a mood of another kind.[189]

267 Without accepting Rādhikā's mood and lustre, I can never taste these three kinds of happiness.

268 Accepting Rādhā's mood and assuming Her colour, I shall descend to taste these three kinds of happiness."

269 With all His heart Kṛṣṇa made this decision, and just then came the time for the avatāra of the age.[190]

270 At that time Śrī Advaita was worshipping the Lord, and with His thunderous call He drew Kṛṣṇa down.[191]

271–272 First causing His father, mother and elders to descend, and accepting Rādhikā's mood and complexion, Kṛṣṇa appeared as the full moon in Navadvīpa, in the pure ocean of milk that was Śacī's womb.[192]

273 So I have explained the sixth verse, meditating on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi.[193]

274 For the meaning I have given of these two verses, a verse of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi is a fitting proof.

275 “Eager for delight, the Lord stole from one among the host of His beloveds (Śrī Rādhā) Her boundless wealth of rasa, indescribably sweet, that He might relish it Himself. For this He covered His own lustre and revealed here Her radiance. May He, in the form of Caitanya, be boundlessly merciful to us!” (Stava-mālā, the second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 3)[194]

276 Thus the six verses set forth the auspicious invocation, the characteristic marks of the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and the purpose of His descent.[195]

277 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. In the edition the verse is headed “By the grace of Gaura, the nature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa ascertained”. *Anubhāṣya*: “a child” — one who knows nothing; “His form” — the form of Gaura, who is not different from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; “the Enjoyer in Vraja” — the son of the king of Vraja; “ascertainment” — pointing out the truth (*tattva*). ↩
2. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «এতো» (another reading: «এহো», “this too”); the sense is the same. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Gaurāṅga descended to preach bhakti and the name of Kṛṣṇa; that reason is true, but it is external, not the hidden one. ↩
3. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «হেন» (“so”); another reading has «যেন» (“as”); the sense is the same. ↩
4. In the edition the verse is headed: “Viṣṇu’s work is the deliverance of the saints and the destruction of the wicked; it is not the work of Kṛṣṇa Himself.” ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Catur-vyūha are Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; Matsya and the others are partial avatāras (*aṁśāvatāra*). All the avatāras are parts of the complete Bhagavān and take shelter in Him, and so

Viṣṇu, the maintainer of the world, was then present within the form of Kṛṣṇa. ↩

6. In the edition the verse is headed: “Viṣṇu descends to preach *vidhi-bhakti*; Kṛṣṇa comes as Gaura to preach *rāga-bhakti*.” ↩
7. The same verse as Ādi 3.16 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in love born of the awareness of majesty prema slackens, and Kṛṣṇa takes no pleasure in it; one who thinks himself lowly and Him the Lord loves Him with that awareness, and to such love He is not subject. ↩
8. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord speaks this verse about the cause of His manifest pastimes; “I reward” — “I show favour”; “My path” — the path of perfection. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “O Pārtha, in whatever way one worships Me, in that way I become attainable to him; all men follow the path shown by Me.” ↩
9. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: pure devotion (*śuddha-bhakti*) is the cultivation of Kṛṣṇa with a favourable intent, free of other desires and uncovered by knowledge and fruitive work. *Anubhāṣya*: devotion mixed with other desires, knowledge, work or yoga is “mixed devotion” (*viddha-bhakti*); devotion by rule (*vaidhī*) assists pure devotion, but the word *śuddha-bhakti* points to the service of the *rāgānugā* path — the devotion of Goloka, full of rāga, while *vaidhī-bhakti*, full of reverence, belongs to Vaikuṇṭha. ↩
10. Kṛṣṇa’s words to the gopīs at Kurukṣetra (Samanta-pañcaka), where, at a solar eclipse, both the Yādavas from Dvārakā and Nanda Mahārāja with all Vraja had come. *Anubhāṣya*: “immortality” — eternal service as the Lord’s associate; their love “brings Me” — grants direct meeting with Him; “by good fortune” — “by My good fortune”. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: the rebuke with which the lover (*āśraya*), in pure attachment, chides the Beloved (*viṣaya*) is a sign of utmost, exclusive love; where the Beloved is honoured as worshipful, natural love slackens, and so such rebuke stands higher than the awe-filled praise of the Vedas. ↩
12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the pastimes not found in Vaikuṇṭha and the other worlds Kṛṣṇa will show in this descent, and in them He Himself will be astonished. *Anubhāṣya*: in Vaikuṇṭha and the other realms beyond māyā the Lord’s pastimes do not give Him Himself the ever-new joy of wonder; the excellence of the pastimes of Goloka, where He lives for His own joy, He wishes to show in the world to devotees in whom the sense of majesty prevails. ↩
13. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Yogamāyā is Kṛṣṇa’s own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*); by His will and by her inconceivable power she awakens in the hearts of His eternal beloveds, the gopīs, the mood of *upapati* towards Him. *Anubhāṣya*: the

tendency to *parakīyā* service, in which the lover, drawn by a sweetness (*mādhurya*) that surpasses majesty, passes beyond all ordained reverence, comes from Yogamāyā; this working of the spiritual (*cinmayī*) māyā is unknown even to the Beloved Himself, and is possible only through Yogamāyā, the embodiment of His grace. ↩

14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: for the nourishment of rasa My inconceivable potency will cover My omniscience and give rise to a wondrous rasa, and the gopīs, though they are the Lord's own potency, will not know it either. ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the pure rāga that Kṛṣṇa will show in Vraja is the means by which He gives rasa to all devotees: hearing of it, they will leave *dharma-karma* and worship Him on the path of rāga. ↩
16. In the edition the verse is headed: "Only the liberated soul, perfected on the path of *rāgānugā*, is fit to hear the transcendental *rāsa-līlā*." *Anubhāṣya*: this is Śukadeva's answer to Parīkṣit's question about the truth and the need of Kṛṣṇa's *parakīyā* pastimes; "a human body" — the supreme, transcendental body that resembles a human one; "having heard" — even an outsider, gaining faith in the Lord, must become devoted to Kṛṣṇa's service. One who, not understanding the transcendental nature of these pastimes, takes "such pastimes" for worldly enjoyment only distorts their meaning (as the *prākṛta-sahajiyās* do); the principal sense of the word "such" is transcendental love (*rati*). ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: seeing an injunction in the word *bhavet*, let no one think that the path of *rāgānugā*, open only to those who have gained a taste (*ruci*), is a path of rules open to anyone, even to one full of *anarthas* and seeking enjoyment. Injunctions and prohibitions belong to this world; in Goloka-Vṛndāvana there are none — there all who have taken shelter, moved by longing, seek only one thing: Kṛṣṇa's pleasure. ↩
18. In the edition verse 37 is headed: "Establishing dharma and the like is not the main work of Kṛṣṇa in His own form, nor of Gaura." ↩
19. In the edition the verse is headed: "The meeting of the Source of all avatāras with His own part, the avatāra of the age." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when the complete Bhagavān resolved to descend for a hidden reason, the time of the *yuga-dharma* happened to arrive; so Gaurāṅga descended for two reasons — the inner, hidden one and the outer one, the preaching of the *yuga-dharma* — and with His devotees tasted prema and *nāma-saṅkīrtana*. ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: wishing to show His pastimes of magnanimity, Kṛṣṇa manifested in the world His eternal pastimes as Gaura, and the wonder of these eternal pastimes is that Kṛṣṇa takes the mood of a devotee. The *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, not understanding transcendental separation (*vipralambha*), distort this mood of a

devotee: they want to dress Śrī Gaurasundara as an enjoyer (*sambhoga-vigraha*) and call themselves "Gaura-nāgarīs", thereby destroying the mood of the *āśraya*; Kṛṣṇa is not pleased with them, and Śrī Gaura rejects them. ↩

21. In the edition the verse is headed: "Apart from *śānta*, those who hold these four rasas desire only Kṛṣṇa's pleasure." *Śṛṅgāra* is the love of the beloved ones of Vraja, which in the gopīs is *parakīyā* (4.46–47), not a conjugal relationship (see Ādi 1.4 and 3.11). ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: to each of the four kinds of devotees his own rasa seems best, but seen impartially the sweetness of *madhura*, that is, of *śṛṅgāra-rasa*, surpasses the other three. The edition's heading: on impartial consideration the transcendental *madhura-rasa* includes all the other rasas, and so the effort to please Kṛṣṇa is greatest in it. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: "in ascending order" — rising step by step; "by inclination" — by the difference of inclinations. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *rati*, full of delight, reveals itself in ever new tastes and, according to inclination, shows in the best hearts the highest taste — *madhura-rasa*. ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when *madhura-rasa* awakens towards Kṛṣṇa as one's husband, it is *svakīyā*; when towards Him as a lover who is not one's husband (*upapati*), it is *parakīyā*. The *Anubhāṣya*, after the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*: *svakīyā* are the beloveds who became His wives by the law of scripture and are faithful to Him as husband (the queens of Dvārakā); *parakīyā* are those who out of rāga alone have given themselves to Kṛṣṇa, regarding neither this world nor the next, though dharma does not recognise them as His wives. ↩
25. In the edition the verse is headed: "Of these, Kṛṣṇa's pleasure is greatest in the *parakīyā* mood, and its only abode is Vraja." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the knowers of *madhura-rasa* have unanimously concluded that in the *parakīyā* mood the delight of rasa is greatest and that outside Vraja it does not exist. Some think that Kṛṣṇa, who sports eternally in Goloka, only for a short time appeared in Vraja in this mood; but that is not the view of the Gosvāmīs: the pastimes of Vraja too are eternal, and Vraja is the innermost chamber of eternal Goloka. ↩
26. In the edition the verse is headed: "The *parakīyā* mood dwells eternally in the ladies of Vraja and reaches its climax in Śrī Rādhā." ↩
27. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the mature, spotless love of Śrī Rādhā in Vraja is the highest of all; whatever tasting of Kṛṣṇa's *mādhurya-rasa* is possible at all, it comes through her. ↩
28. In the edition the verse is headed: "Accepting the mood of Śrī Rādhā, in the form of Gaura He fulfils His three desires." ↩

29. *Anubhāṣya*: *durgam* — “a refuge hard to attain” for Mahendra and the other lords of the gods; “the all-in-all of the sages” — the only wealth of those who have turned away from matter; “sweetness” — the abode of beauty for the hosts of devotees. ↩
30. *Anubhāṣya*: “eager for delight” (*kutukī*) — He who rejoices in tasting the moods; “to relish” — to taste it Himself by accepting Her mood; “His own lustre” — His form, dark as a rain-cloud; “Her radiance” — the beauty of her who embodies love for Him; the Lord is the Beloved of the gopīs. The same verse recurs as 4.275. ↩
31. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: with the intention of accepting Śrī Rādhā’s mood He engaged in establishing dharma; the chief purpose of that work is now being told. *Anubhāṣya*: some readings have six lines here instead of these four. ↩
32. The same verse as Ādi 1.5; in the edition, “a verse from the *Kaḍacā* (notes) of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī”; here begins the explanation of the fifth of the fourteen opening verses. *Anubhāṣya*: Rādhā is “the transformation of Kṛṣṇa’s love — the *hlādinī-śakti* in the form of the play of prema”; the Two are “of one Self”; Their two forms are the *viṣaya* and the *āśraya* of love, “from beginningless time” (*purā*); in Śrī Caitanya — “Kṛṣṇa within, Gaura without”. ↩
33. In the edition the verse is headed: “The beginning of the explanation of the fifth verse: the hidden cause of Gaura’s descent; first, the truth of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the words of these verses are plain, but their inner sense is deep. Rādhā is the potency (*śakti*), Kṛṣṇa the possessor of potency; the Vedānta’s words “the potency and its possessor are not different” mean that a potency cannot be separated from its bearer; yet by inconceivable power Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are eternally separate, to taste the rasa of pastimes with each other, and at the same time one. ↩
34. In the edition the verse is headed: “Gaura — the form in which Rādhā and Govinda are united.” ↩
35. In the edition the verse is headed: “To describe the glory of the truth of Gaura — an explanation of the love of Rādhā and Govinda.” ↩
36. In the edition the verse is headed: “The truth of Śrī Rādhā and Her relation to Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
37. In the edition the verse is headed: “The nature of the Hlādinī potency.” *Anubhāṣya*, after Śrī Jīva’s *Prīti-sandarbha* (65): the śruti says, “Devotion alone leads one to Him, devotion alone shows Him; the Puruṣa is subject to devotion, devotion is the greatest”; and what is it that maddens even the Lord with His own bliss? It is His own potency of bliss, Hlādinī. ↩

38. In the edition the verse is headed: “The one potency of the one Possessor of potency in three forms: (1) giving bliss, the taste of rasa; (2) acting and enjoying; (3) manifesting existence.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa, the complete Truth and possessor of potency, is eternity, knowledge and bliss. His one spiritual potency in the aspect of being is Sandhinī, which extends existence; in the aspect of knowledge Samvit, complete knowledge, the very nature of Kṛṣṇa; in the aspect of bliss Hlādinī, who gives joy to Him Himself. ↩
39. *Anubhāṣya* (after Śrī Jīva’s *Bhagavat-sandarbha*, 102): Sandhinī is the potency by which the Lord upholds His own being and that of all, and manifests time, place and all else; Samvit is that by which He knows and makes others know; Hlādinī is that by which He Himself tastes bliss and makes others taste it. The self-luminous working of this one supreme potency is called *viśuddha-sattva*: in it there is no touch of māyā, and from it the abode of Vaikuṇṭha is manifest. ↩
40. In the edition, “the words of Dhruva”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in You, the shelter of all and beyond the guṇas, the three workings of the potency — Hlādinī, Sandhinī and Samvit — are wholly spiritual; only the jīva, a tiny spark subject to māyā, dwelling in the three guṇas, knows this potency as giving joy (*hlādakarī*), pain (*tāpakarī*) or both (*miśrā*); in You it is pure and one. *Anubhāṣya* (after Śrī Jīva’s *Prīti-sandarbha*, 65): the potency by which the Lord delights in His bliss is not the worldly bliss of *sattva*, as the Sāṅkhyas hold, for māyā has no power over the Lord; nor the bliss of His impersonal essence, as those who hold Him to be without attributes say; nor the bliss of the jīva, for the jīva is tiny. It is His own potency Hlādinī: through it He tastes a special bliss, and through it He gives that bliss to His devotees; and so the conclusion of the impersonalists must be rejected. ↩
41. In the edition the verse is headed: “The service of Sandhinī — to make Bhagavān manifest.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the essence of Sandhinī, the potency that extends being, is called *śuddha-sattva*. *Sattva* is of two kinds, mixed (*miśra*) and pure (*śuddha*); *sattva* is the name of being itself, and without the working of Sandhinī there is no being at all; the manifestation of Bhagavān’s being is also her work. ↩
42. In the edition the verse is headed: “Though Kṛṣṇa is the Lord of Sandhinī, all that He enjoys is her transformation.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Sandhinī of the spiritual world manifests the being of all that is spiritual — Bhagavān’s form, His servants and maidservants, His companions, His father and mother; Sandhinī in māyā extends the being of the material world, and in the jīva

potency, the being of the jīva, a spiritual spark. *Anubhāṣya*: *śuddha-sattva* is not worldly *sattva* (goodness): the guṇas belong to the jīvas, not to the Lord. ↩

43. The words of Śiva to Satī when she was about to go to the sacrifice of her father Dakṣa, who was hostile to Viṣṇu (*Anubhāṣya*). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the eternal truth in the form of *śuddha-sattva*, born of the working of Sandhinī in the Lord's own potency, is called *vasudeva*; in that *śuddha-sattva* Bhagavān, conscious by nature, is eternally manifest, and His name is Vāsudeva; He is beyond all material senses, and to Him, with a heart purified by bhakti, Śiva offers obeisance. ↩
44. In the edition the verse is headed: "Through Samvit are known His mastery of experience and His enjoyment of bliss, and, within non-dual knowledge, the knowledge of Bhagavān." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the working of Samvit is called knowledge. When the spiritual Samvit, joined with Hlādinī, shows mercy to the jīva, the knowledge that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān awakens in him — this is the essence of Samvit; the knowledge of Brahman and the knowledge of the world are its "retinue", that is, only coverings at different stages. ↩
45. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the working of Hlādinī is called prema. Prema is pure or mixed: when Hlādinī in Kṛṣṇa, giving Him bliss, together with pure Samvit shows mercy to the jīva, love for Kṛṣṇa is born in the jīva; but when the transformation of Hlādinī in the jīva draws him, through māyā, towards the world, the jīva, intoxicated with worldly love, loses love for Kṛṣṇa and falls under the sway of joy and sorrow. The ideal of love for the jīvas is the gopīs of Vraja, and highest among them is Śrī Rādhā. ↩
46. In the edition verse 68 is headed "The divisions of Hlādinī", and verse 69 "Śrī Rādhikā — the summit of love for Kṛṣṇa in person". ↩
47. *Anubhāṣya*: the two are Śrī Rādhā and Candrāvalī; "the embodiment of *mahābhāva*" — She in whom is the *mahābhāva* called *madana*, whose form unites the eight *bhāvas*; "in virtues" — in Her twenty-five qualities. The reference follows the edition. ↩
48. In the edition the verse is headed: "Within and without, in every part of Her form, love for Kṛṣṇa is manifest." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śrīmatī Rādhikā is wholly spiritual: unlike the conditioned jīva She has no material senses, body or subtle mind — Her mind, senses and body are spiritual and steeped in love for Kṛṣṇa. She is Kṛṣṇa's own potency and therefore the only helper in His play: Kṛṣṇa, the possessor of potency, cannot play apart from His potency. ↩
49. In the edition the verse is headed: "Govinda in Goloka eternally sports in rasa with the gopīs." *Anubhāṣya*: "the Soul of all" — the beloved of all the dwellers of Gokula; "imbued with rasa" — steeped at every moment in blissful spiritual

rasa; “one with Him in nature” — known as His own essence; the *kalās* are forms of the Hlādinī potency, that is, the beauties of Vraja. ↩

50. In the edition verse 74 is headed: “In *madhura-rati*, by the mood of majesty or of sweetness, three kinds of Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “the third kind” — the girls of Vraja, the essence, that is, the best of all beloveds. ↩
51. In the edition the verse is headed: “All Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds are parts of Rādhā, the source of parts.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: as Kṛṣṇa, the Source of all avatāras, manifests the Puruṣa and the other avatāras, so Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the source (*aṁśinī*) of all beloveds: from Her parts come the Lakṣmīs, the queens and the girls of Vraja. ↩
52. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the beloveds who come from Her are counted as Her *vaibhava*, the splendour of Her body; in the form of reflections (*bimba-pratibimba*) the queens expand from Her. *Anubhāṣya*: some readings have, instead of “the *vaibhavas* are, as it were, the splendour of Her body”, “the Lakṣmīs are the splendour of Her parts”. ↩
53. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «প্রাভব» (another reading: «বৈভব»); so too the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “the Lakṣmīs are parts of Her *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśa*”. In the edition the verse is headed: “The queens in Dvārakā, and the Lakṣmīs of Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva and others.” ↩
54. In the edition the verse is headed: “Lalitā and the other girls of Vraja — expansions of Her form (*kāya-vyūha*).” ↩
55. In the edition the verse is headed: “For the increase of rasa and its wonder — many manifestations of the one Hlādinī.” ↩
56. In the edition the verse is headed: “Among them, the pastimes of Vraja are the highest wonder of love for Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
57. In the edition the verse is headed: “The five names of Śrī Rādhikā”: Govindānandinī (“she who delights Govinda”), Rādhā, Govinda-mohinī (“she who enchants Govinda”), Govinda-sarvasva (“Govinda’s all-in-all”), Sarva-kāntā-śiromaṇi (“the crest-jewel of all beloveds”). ↩
58. The author explains the words of this verse in what follows: *devī* — 4.84; *kṛṣṇa-mayī* — 4.85–86; *Rādhikā* — 4.87–88; “the supreme deity” — 4.89; *sarva-lakṣmī* — 4.90–91; *sarva-kānti* — 4.92–94; “the enchantress” — 4.95. ↩
59. In the edition the verse is headed: “The meaning of the verse: (1) the abode of beauty or of play.” ↩
60. In the edition the verse is headed: “(2) Complete absorption in Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
61. In the edition the verse is headed: “Non-difference from Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
62. In the edition the verse is headed: “(3) The name ‘Rādhā’ — because She worships Kṛṣṇa by fulfilling His desires.” ↩

63. In the edition the verse is headed: “A hint of Rādhā’s name in the *Bhāgavatam*.” The words of the gopīs searching for Kṛṣṇa on the night of the rāsa dance: *anayārādhitaḥ*, “worshipped by Her”, holds within it the name of Rādhā. ↩
64. In the edition the verse is headed: “(4) As the one who attracts Kṛṣṇa She is highest of all; She nourishes all devotees and all devotion and is their original source.” ↩
65. In the edition the verse is headed: “(5) The source (*aṁśinī*) of all Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds.” ↩
66. In the edition the verse is headed: “The original shelter of all the potencies of Kṛṣṇa’s majesty.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Rādhikā is the shelter of all the Lakṣmīs; or *sarva-lakṣmī* means Kṛṣṇa’s sixfold opulence, and She is His potency that presides over it. ↩
67. In the edition verse 92 is headed “The original source of all beauty”, and verse 93 “The fulfilment of Kṛṣṇa’s desires in person”. ↩
68. In the edition the verse is headed: “(6) The enchantress of Him who enchants the world.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: with this verse the explanation of each word of the verse “*Devī kṛṣṇa-mayī…*” (4.83) is complete. ↩
69. In the edition the verse is headed: “The full-moon night of Kṛṣṇa, the full moon.” ↩
70. In the edition the verse is headed: “Like musk and its scent, or fire and its flame, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are inseparable.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: musk and its scent are two things, yet inseparable; so too fire and its flame; and so Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, eternally distinct in order to taste the rasa of pastimes, are one essence. ↩
71. In the edition the verse is headed: “Though one essence, two bodies — as the One who tastes and the One who is tasted.” ↩
72. In the edition verse 99 is headed: “To distribute Śrī Rādhā’s love for Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa comes as Gaura, taking Rādhā’s mood and form”; *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “lustre” (*kānti*) — the beauty of Rādhikā’s complexion. ↩
73. In the edition the verse is headed: “The beginning of the explanation of the sixth of the fourteen opening verses.” ↩
74. In the edition the verse is headed: “A preamble: inaugurating *nāma-saṅkīrtana* is the external reason for Gaura’s descent.” ↩
75. In the edition the verse is headed: “The chief and hidden reason — the work of Kṛṣṇa Himself; it was known only to Gaura’s second self, Śrī Dāmodara-svarūpa.” ↩
76. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the chief reason for Gaura’s descent is very hidden, and it is of three kinds; it is told later in the root verse “*Śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-*

mahimā…” (4.230). ↩

77. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Puruṣottama Bhaṭṭācārya lived in Navadvīpa. Even before Mahāprabhu’s sannyāsa, wishing to take sannyāsa, he went to Vārāṇasī and became a *brahmacārī* among the Daśanāmī *daṇḍīs*; then he was named Śrī Dāmodara-svarūpa. Without waiting for full sannyāsa, he lived for the rest of his life at Mahāprabhu’s lotus feet in Nīlācala, always beside Him, and by singing what He asked for gave Him the highest joy at every moment; by his grace the devotees came to know the hidden moods of the Lord’s heart. In the pastimes of Vraja he is Lalitā-devī, Rādhikā’s second self; according to Kavi Karṇapūra’s *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, Viśākhā-devī: “She who in Vraja taught Rādhā the arts, Viśākhā, is now Svarūpa Gosvāmī, who delights in those moods.” ↩
78. In the edition the verse is headed: “Gaurasundara, immersed in Rādhā’s *mahābhāva*.” *Anubhāṣya*: the heart of Śrī Gaurasundara is filled with a form woven of the moods of Śrī Rādhikā; people of gross mind, busy gratifying the senses, cannot understand what “the embodiment of a mood” means. Rādhikā’s mood is the highest and complete stage of *mādhurya*; it is *rūḍha* or *adhirūḍha*, and here the *adhirūḍha-mahābhāva* of Śrī Gaurasundara is meant. ↩
79. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সদা» (“always”); another reading has «আর» (“and”). *Anubhāṣya*: in the conduct of a perfected soul Śrī Gaurahari displays the supreme height of *vipralambha-rasa*; those who trust only the knowledge of the senses take His experiences for delirium and wandering of mind. The doctrine of the “Nadīyā-nāgarīs”, which distorts the path of following, is only an attempt at sense gratification, not the path shown by Śrī Gaurasundara; its adherents are materialists and therefore enemies of Viṣṇu. ↩
80. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa sent Uddhava from Mathurā to the gopīs with news of Himself, and on seeing Uddhava Śrīmatī Rādhikā showed wondrous moods. *Anubhāṣya*: on seeing Uddhava, Kṛṣṇa’s friend, Rādhikā voiced in many kinds of speech a hidden anger full of feeling and of utmost longing — this is *citra-jalpa* (*Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*: “speech full of many moods at the sight of the Beloved’s friend, in which hidden anger shows through, and the utmost longing”); in that “Mathurā” mood Śrī Gaurasundara, one with Śrī Rādhā, was intoxicated day and night. ↩
81. In the edition the verse is headed: “The Lord reveals the moods of His heart, and Svarūpa gives Him joy.” ↩
82. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “later” — in the Antya-līlā. ↩
83. In the edition the verse is headed: “The three ages in Vraja.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *kaumāra* lasts up to five years, *paugaṇḍa* up to ten, *kaiśora* from

eleven to sixteen, and then *yauvana*; in *kaumāra* there is *vātsalya*, in *paugaṇḍa sakhya*, and in *kaiśora śṛṅgāra-rasa*. ↩

84. In the edition verse 113 is headed “Different pastimes in the different ages of Kṛṣṇa”, and verse 114 “In the pastimes of youth — the fulfilment of the purpose of all”. ↩
85. The *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* reads the verse otherwise: Kāma is Kṛṣṇa Himself, Manmatha in person, who by His own will, performing the rāsa dance and other pastimes in His youth, made the whole world and His three ages — childhood, boyhood and youth — fruitful. The translation follows the plain sense of the verse, which 4.116 (youth) and 4.118 (the world and Kāma) explain. ↩
86. *Anubhāṣya*: *kṣapitāhita* — “He by whom all that is inauspicious is destroyed”; “honouring His youth” — making it fruitful; “jewels among women” — the gopīs; “at night” — on autumn nights. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: amid Rādhā, full of *mahābhāva*, and the gopīs, full of *bhāva*, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the supreme Consciousness, is the central (*kūṭa-stha*) Truth. ↩
87. The reference follows the edition (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, first *laharī*, verse 231). *Anubhāṣya*: here Kṛṣṇa is shown as the *dhīra-lalita* hero, carefree and skilled in play and jest; “the utmost skill” is said in jest: as He drew, His hand trembled, the picture went crooked, and He corrected it again and again. *Makarīs* are wondrous sea creatures, a design used to adorn the body. ↩
88. *Anubhāṣya*: the words of Śrī Vṛndā-devī to Paurṇamāsī; “Mathurā” — the district of Mathurā, which includes Vraja. ↩
89. In the edition verse 119 is headed: “In Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes three desires remained unfulfilled.” ↩
90. In the edition the verse is headed: “(1) The first desire.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “the source of rasa” (*rasera nidāna*); some readings have *rasera nidhāna*, “the treasury of rasa”. ↩
91. In the edition the verse is headed: “A consideration of the power and depth of Rādhā’s love.” ↩
92. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «প্রতিতরুলতাং»; so too the *Anubhāṣya* (another reading: «প্রতিতরুলতং»). The edition’s root text here also has the misprints «নিত্যশিক্ষাং» and «ত্বং»; the *Anubhāṣya* reads «নৃত্যশিক্ষাম্» (“the learning of dance”) and «তং (কৃষ্ণং)» (“Him, Kṛṣṇa”). *Anubhāṣya*: a conversation between Śrī Rādhā and Vṛndā within the midday pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; *śailūṣī* — a skilled dancer. ↩
93. In the edition the verse is headed: “A comparison of the mutual love of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā, and its special nature.” ↩

94. In the edition the verse is headed: “An explanation of the mutual love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: as Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of opposite qualities — changeless yet acting by His own will, all-pervading yet having a beautiful form, dependent on none yet partial to His devotees, self-satisfied yet longing for His devotees’ love — so Rādhā’s love is full of opposite qualities: it is the ultimate *mahābhāva* and yet ever growing, full of greatness and yet free of pride, pure and yet full of contrariness. ↩
95. In the edition the verse is headed: “An example of the opposite qualities in Rādhā’s love.” ↩
96. *Anubhāṣya*: “all-pervading” — omnipresent; “free of pride” — free of service out of mere courtesy, for it is born of a honeyed affection (*madhu-sneha*) full of the sense “He is mine”; “crookedness” — contrariness (*vāmya*); “pure” — unmotivated. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Rādhikā’s love, though it has reached its limit, ever grows; though weighty, it does not act with importance; though pure, it again and again takes a crooked path. Glory to such love of Rādhikā for Kṛṣṇa! ↩
97. In the edition the verse is headed: “The *viṣaya* of that love is Kṛṣṇa, the *āśraya* Rādhikā.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the one who loves is the *āśraya* of love, the one who is loved its *viṣaya*. In the science of rasa there are four ingredients: *vibhāva*, *anubhāva*, sāttvika and *vyabhicārī*; *vibhāva* is *ālambana* and *uddīpana*; *ālambana* is *viṣaya* and *āśraya*. The *āśraya* of Rādhā’s love is Rādhikā, its only *viṣaya* Kṛṣṇa. The happiness Kṛṣṇa tastes is the happiness of the *viṣaya*; the bliss of the *āśraya* is ten million times greater, and only by becoming the *āśraya* of that love can He taste it — this longing is His first desire. ↩
98. In the edition the verse is headed: “A comparison of the happiness of the *viṣaya* and of the *āśraya*.” ↩
99. In the edition the verse is headed: “Seeing that the *āśraya*’s happiness is greater, the *viṣaya* longs to become the *āśraya*.” ↩
100. In the edition the verse is headed: “(2) The second desire.” ↩
101. In the edition the verse is headed: “Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness astonishes and attracts even Himself.” ↩
102. In the edition the verse is headed: “Śrī Rādhā’s love is full and yet grows at every moment.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the second desire is this: Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness is wondrous, endless and boundless, and Rādhikā alone tastes it, with the love of the *āśraya*. The mirror of Her pure love is perfectly clear, yet its clearness grows at every moment; Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness, boundless and so unable

to grow, grows and shines ever new before that mirror; so His sweetness and Rādhā's love vie with each other, and neither will yield. ↩

103. *Anubhāṣya*: *hoḍa kari'* — "vying". ↩
104. In the edition the verse is headed: "To taste His own sweetness He longs to take the form of Her who tastes it." ↩
105. *Anubhāṣya*: in Dvārakā, in Nava-Vṛndāvana, Śrī Kṛṣṇa sees His own beauty in His reflection on a jewelled wall and says: "never before experienced, causing wonder, weightier than all — My indescribable flood of sweetness, a treasure of beauty, appears here; and I, Kṛṣṇa, seeing this reflection, like Rādhikā, with a greedy heart eagerly desire to enjoy it." The *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* reads *kaḥ* as a question: "Who is this never-seen, astonishing, wondrously depicted Person? Seeing Him, I, like Rādhikā, long to embrace Him." ↩
106. In the edition the verse is headed: "The power of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness, and His effort to taste it." *Anubhāṣya*: beginning with Kṛṣṇa Himself — the gopīs, Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa, Lakṣmī and all other beings — Kṛṣṇa's sweetness by its nature is able to stir them all. ↩
107. In the edition the verse is headed: "Kṛṣṇa's sweetness brings no worldly satiety — only the longing grows." ↩
108. *Anubhāṣya*: Śukadeva describes the gopīs' feelings for Kṛṣṇa after the meeting of the cowherds with the Vṛṣṇis at Kurukṣetra: gazing at Kṛṣṇa, they rebuked the Creator who made the eyelids that hinder sight; "the ever-united" — yogīs who have reached perfection; "that state" — dense supreme bliss. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: that state is unattainable even for yogīs who meditate on Brahman. ↩
109. *Anubhāṣya*: the song of the gopīs' lament when Kṛṣṇa vanished during the rāsa dance; "a moment" (*truṭi*) — even half an instant becomes for them a *yuga*; "the maker of eyelids" — the Creator who made blinking — is a fool. ↩
110. In the edition the verse is headed: "For a fortunate jīva, the purpose of the eyes is to see Kṛṣṇa's form." ↩
111. *Anubhāṣya*: the song of the gopīs about Kṛṣṇa at the coming of autumn; the two sons of the lord of Vraja are Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, who drive the cows from forest to forest playing the flute; "loving glances" — tender glances, drunk by those who serve Them with their eyes. ↩
112. In the edition the verse is headed: "The women of Mathurā marvel at the gopīs' good fortune." *Anubhāṣya*: the words of the women gathered in Kaṁsa's arena at Mathurā, when they saw Rāma and Kṛṣṇa wrestling with Muṣṭika and Cāṇūra; Kṛṣṇa's form is "not perfected by anything else" — it is perfect in itself, not through ornaments; "new at every moment". ↩

113. In the edition the verse is headed: “(3) The third desire.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: though Kṛṣṇa longs to taste His sweetness fully with the love of the *āśraya*, He cannot, and is troubled; this is the second hidden reason why He accepts Rādhikā’s mood. ↩
114. In the edition the verse is headed: “Dāmodara-svarūpa alone is the original *mahājana* of the nectar of *bhakti-rasa*.” ↩
115. In the edition the verse is headed: “The name of the gopīs’ love.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the name of this love is *rūḍha-bhāva*; pure prema cannot in truth be expressed by the word *kāma*. *Anubhāṣya*: in the gopīs’ *mahābhāva* the sāttvika-bhāvas blaze, and so their love is called *rūḍha-bhāva* (“where the sāttvika-bhāvas blaze, that *bhāva* is called *rūḍha*”); their love is wholly directed to Kṛṣṇa’s happiness and is therefore pure — the contemptible word *kāma*, which means enjoyment of anything other than Kṛṣṇa, cannot apply to it. ↩
116. In the edition the verse is headed: “In the gopīs, *kāma* and prema are one.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: it became customary to call the pure prema of the cowherd women *kāma*; devotees of the Lord such as Uddhava thirst for that love. *Anubhāṣya*: “Uddhava and others” — devotees who relish other rasas. ↩
117. In the edition the verse is headed: “The nature of *kāma* and prema, and their difference.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: as iron and gold differ in nature, so *kāma* and prema, though they seem almost one, differ in their marks. ↩
118. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*): “The bond of feeling between the young pair that is never destroyed, even when causes of destruction arise, is called prema”; the gopīs, as *āśraya*, are firmly bound to Kṛṣṇa by this bond, and, as the ideal of giving up one’s own happiness — which is *kāma* — they are wholly devoted to the service that gives Kṛṣṇa bliss. ↩
119. In the edition the verse is headed: “The aim of *kāma* and the aim of prema.” ↩
120. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «দুস্ত্যজ্য» (another reading: «দুস্ত্যজ»); the sense is the same. In the edition verse 167 is headed: “The marks and nature of love for Kṛṣṇa.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Vedas speak of the desire for the world, for sons and for wealth — these are social custom, Vedic religion, bodily needs, work, shame, restraint, bodily happiness, “one’s own happiness” such as liberation, the path of the noble, attachment to one’s family, fear of the beatings and rebukes of relatives; all these are desires to please one’s own senses, that is, *kāma*. Desires that follow the conviction “I am Kṛṣṇa’s servant” can be desires to please Kṛṣṇa, but those born of the conviction “I am the enjoyer of fruits” are *kāma*. The “renunciation of all” (4.169) does not mean giving up the activities of body and mind: if they are moved by the conviction “I am Kṛṣṇa’s servant”, that too is not *kāma*. ↩

121. In the edition the verse is headed: “The difference between *kāma* and prema.” ↩
122. In the edition the verse is headed: “*Kāma* and the gopīs’ love for Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
123. In the edition the verse is headed: “The depth of the gopīs’ love for Kṛṣṇa.” *Anubhāṣya*: the song of the gopīs’ lament when Kṛṣṇa vanished during the rāsa dance; “afraid” — fearing that the touch might hurt; “pebbles” — small sharp stones. ↩
124. In the edition the verse is headed: “The gopīs’ pure love for Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
125. In the edition the verse is headed: “Kṛṣṇa, bound by the gopīs’ love, asks forgiveness for disappearing.” *Anubhāṣya*: the words of Kṛṣṇa, who returned to the place of the rāsa dance on hearing the gopīs’ words; “the laws of society” — worldly dharma, “of the Vedas” — dharma for the world beyond; “loving invisibly” — doing them good unseen by them. ↩
126. In the edition the verse is headed: “The degree to which Kṛṣṇa is attained according to the kind of pure bhakti.” ↩
127. The same verse as 4.20 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it); the translation is the same. ↩
128. In the edition the verse is headed: “Kṛṣṇa’s unpayable debt to the gopīs’ love.” ↩
129. *Anubhāṣya*: hearing the gopīs’ song of lament, Kṛṣṇa appeared and consoled them with these words; *niravadya-saṁyujām* — “of those whose union is faultless, guileless”; “a lifetime of the gods” — the span of the heavenly beings’ life; “let it be requited by the good deed” — let your good deed itself be its own reward. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “you cut the heavy fetters of the world and sought Me; I am unable to pay you My debt.” ↩
130. In the edition the verse is headed: “Even when the gopīs see to their own happiness, their aim is Kṛṣṇa’s happiness.” ↩
131. In the edition the verse is headed “Even in adorning their bodies the gopīs think only of Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure”, and the source is given as “the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa* from the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 40”. *Anubhāṣya*: “as Mine” — “this body is given to the Lord, my Beloved”; “tend” — adorn; “no one is so secretly dear” — there is no other vessel of My hidden love. ↩
132. In the edition the verse is headed: “The gopīs’ happiness in service is ten million times greater than Kṛṣṇa’s happiness.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the gopīs have no desire for happiness, and yet when they see Kṛṣṇa they taste a happiness ten million times greater than Kṛṣṇa’s happiness in seeing them. ↩
133. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সুখে কৃষ্ণসুখ» (another reading: «সুখ কৃষ্ণসুখে»); the sense is the same. ↩

134. In the edition the verse is headed: “The gopīs’ happiness lies in Kṛṣṇa’s happiness.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: though some may call the gopīs’ happiness at seeing Kṛṣṇa *kāma*, the gopīs think, “If Kṛṣṇa sees that we are happy in meeting Him, His joy will grow still more”; so the final cause of their happiness is the desire to please Kṛṣṇa’s senses, and in it there is no fault of *kāma*. ↩
135. In the edition the verse is headed: “The gopīs’ love is not *kāma*, for it increases Kṛṣṇa’s happiness.” ↩
136. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «ততিভিরাভির» (another reading: «ততিভিরভির»). *Anubhāṣya*: the beauties of Vraja have climbed onto the roofs of their houses; Keśava returns victorious to Vraja, to Nandīśvara, from the afternoon pasturing of the cows. ↩
137. In the edition the verse is headed: “A natural mark of the gopīs’ love.” ↩
138. In the edition the verse is headed: “Through the gopīs’ love Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness grows.” ↩
139. In the edition the verse is headed: “The pure love of the serving *āśraya* lies in the love of the served *viṣaya*.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in the bliss of Kṛṣṇa, the *viṣaya* of love, lies the bliss of the gopīs, its *āśraya*; in such abundance of bliss the gopīs have no connection with the desire for their own happiness. Where love is unconditional, this is the law: the happiness of the *āśraya* lies in the happiness of the *viṣaya*. Yet one may say: where there is a bliss of one’s own love, it will surely hinder the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa — and so, where a bliss arises that hinders service, the devotee is filled with great anger. ↩
140. In the edition the verse is headed: “A devotee’s love lies in the love of the Lord; it is pure and spotless.” ↩
141. In the edition the verse is headed: “During Kṛṣṇa’s service the desire for one’s own pleasure is contemptible, to be driven far away.” ↩
142. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: while fanning Kṛṣṇa with a whisk, Dāruka did not welcome the stupor of his body born of the bliss of love, because it hindered his service. ↩
143. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa’s lotus-eyed beloved bitterly reproached the bliss that shed tears hindering her sight of Kṛṣṇa. ↩
144. In the edition the verse is headed: “The pure devotee scorns even liberation without devotion to Kṛṣṇa.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: without loving service to Kṛṣṇa the pure devotee never accepts even liberation — *sālokya* and the rest — if it is for his own happiness. ↩
145. In the edition verses 205–207 are headed: “Only unmotivated and uninterrupted devotion to Kṛṣṇa is beyond the guṇas (*nirguṇa*)” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.29.11–13). *Anubhāṣya*: the words of Śrī Kapiladeva to His mother, Devahūti;

the mind flows towards the Lord, "who dwells within all", and that flow cannot be cut by anything else. ↩

146. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: unmotivated — without cause, self-manifest; uninterrupted — without obstacle and without seeking other fruits. *Anubhāṣya*: unmotivated — free of seeking fruits; uninterrupted — free of obstruction by body, wealth, people, greed, pride and the like; beyond the guṇas — belonging to Bhagavān, who is beyond the three guṇas. ↩
147. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *sālokya* — residence in Vaikuṇṭha, *sārṣṭi* — opulence, *sāmīpya* — nearness, *sārūpya* — a four-armed form, oneness — *sāyujya*, merging; the devotees do not accept them, for apart from transcendental service to the Lord they have nothing to desire. ↩
148. In the edition the verse is headed: "Not to speak of perishable enjoyment, even liberation is not desired by the devotee." *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord's words to Durvāsā as He described the qualities of devotees such as Ambarīṣa; "anything else, destroyed by time" — heaven and the like. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: neither worldly enjoyment nor *sāyujya-mukti*, in which the jīva's existence falls into the jaws of time, is lasting. ↩
149. In the edition the verse is headed: "A description of the gopīs' love." ↩
150. In the edition the verse is headed: "The gopīs' relationship with Kṛṣṇa." ↩
151. The source follows the edition ("the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*"). *Anubhāṣya*: helpers — in the rāsa dance and other pastimes; teachers — in the science of love; disciples — ever attentive to My instruction; servants — serving Me like maidservants; friends — loving like friends; *striyaḥ* — beloveds ("as dear as one's own consort"); "what are they not to Me?" — that is, they are My all-in-all. ↩
152. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *iṣṭa-samīhita* — the endeavours He desires. ↩
153. The source follows the edition (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 39; "the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*"). *Anubhāṣya*: *mac-chraddhām* — "what I long for"; *man-mano-gatam* — "the intent of My mind"; "in truth" — in its very essence; "others" — other devotees. ↩
154. In the edition the verse is headed: "Śrī Rādhikā — the best of the gopīs." ↩
155. The source follows the edition (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45; "the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*"). *Anubhāṣya*: Viṣṇu here is Kṛṣṇa. ↩
156. In the edition the verse is headed: "Among places Vṛndāvana is highest, among devotees Śrī Rādhā"; the source is given as *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 46, "the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*". *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: because the abode of Vṛndāvana has appeared on earth, all three worlds are blessed;

among them the gopīs are blessed, for among them is the gopī named Rādhā, dearer to Me than anyone. ↩

157. In the edition the verse is headed: “In *madhura-rasa* the principal pastimes are with Śrī Rādhā; all else serves them.” *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Rādhikā is everything to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and the other gopīs only serve the rasa of His play with Rādhā. From the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*: “All the fair-browed ones whose charms attract Mādhava are friends of the Mistress of Vṛndāvana, and they are of five kinds: sakhī, *nitya-sakhī*, *prāṇa-sakhī*, *priya-sakhī* and *parama-preṣṭha-sakhī*.” ↩
158. In the edition the verse is headed: “Rādhā, dearest to Kṛṣṇa.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: without Rādhikā the other gopīs cannot be the cause of Kṛṣṇa’s happiness. ↩
159. *Anubhāṣya*: the words of Śrī Jayadeva about how Kṛṣṇa left the place of the rāsa dance and went towards Rādhā, the principal shelter of His rāsa; *saṁsāra* here means “the complete essence” (*samyak sāra*): Rādhā is the chain that fastens His desire for the rāsa dance, the very essence of His pastimes. ↩
160. In the edition the verse is headed: “The principal aim — the fulfilment of the three desires in Rādhā’s mood; the secondary aim — the preaching of the name and of prema.” *Anubhāṣya*: Rādhā’s mood is the disposition of the heart of Śrīmatī Gāndharvikā — Kṛṣṇa’s all-in-all, the *āśraya* of love — wholly given to the service of Kṛṣṇa alone. ↩
161. In the edition the verse is headed: “The son of Nanda, embodiment of *sambhoga-rasa*, is Gaura, embodiment of *vipralambha-rasa*.” ↩
162. In the edition the verse is headed: “The descent of the Taster, taking the mood and lustre of her who tastes.” ↩
163. In the edition the verse is headed: “Kṛṣṇa’s eternal pastimes with the girls of Vraja.” *Anubhāṣya*: “all” — all the cowherd women; “dark and tender” — like many tender blue lotuses of varied hues; “freely” — without restraint; “in spring” — in the season of spring. ↩
164. In the edition the verse is headed: “In His descent as Gaura, Kṛṣṇa, the treasury of rasa, tastes the rasa of the gopīs’ love in many ways.” ↩
165. In the edition the verse is headed: “Only Caitanya’s servants, sheltered in the spiritual potency, know the secret of Gaura’s descent.” ↩
166. In the edition verse 227 is headed: “Obeisance to the devotees of Gaura.” ↩
167. In the edition the verse is headed: “So far an outline of the sixth verse; now the detailed explanation.” ↩
168. The same verse as Ādi 1.6; in the edition, “a verse from the *Kaḍacā* of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī”. *Anubhāṣya*: *mad-anubhavataḥ* — “from experiencing Me”: Rādhā’s happiness comes from relishing Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness; *tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ* —

"rich with Her mood"; *harīnduḥ* — the moon Kṛṣṇa. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: longing to know these three — the greatness of Śrī Rādhā's love, His wondrous sweetness that Śrī Rādhā tastes, and the happiness that arises in Her from relishing His sweetness — the moon Kṛṣṇa was born in the ocean of Śacī's womb. ↩

169. In the edition the verse is headed: "Though hidden, it is described for the sake of devotees who relish rasa." *Anubhāṣya*: this hidden truth of Gaura's descent — the desire in Kṛṣṇa's heart — is not fit to be revealed to the world and is beyond the listeners' capacity; yet if it is not revealed, the jīva cannot by his own effort grasp its depth. ↩
170. In the edition the verse is headed: "Only the servants of Śrī Guru and Gaurāṅga are qualified for the conclusions about rasa." ↩
171. *Anubhāṣya*: all this gladdens only the devotees of Gaura and Nityānanda. Gaura's devotees are like cuckoos, and the conclusions are like mango shoots: as the cuckoo prizes mango shoots, so the devotees find the highest joy in these. But as a camel will not eat mango shoots unless it can lacerate its tongue on thorns, so the non-devotee "camels" — *jñānīs*, *karmīs*, people with other desires, and pseudo-devotees — raise empty arguments against these conclusions. ↩
172. In the edition the verse is headed: "Fear of the non-devotee's ill mind — but joy in his not understanding." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: there is joy in my heart that the non-devotees who are to be feared will have no way into this book. ↩
173. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সবে কহে» ("all call"); another reading omits «সবে». In the edition the verse is headed: "Before the sweetness of Hlādinī, the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa is lesser and is defeated." ↩
174. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «গীত» ("the song"); another reading has «গীতে» ("by the song"); the sense is the same. ↩
175. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «চিত্ত-প্রাণ» ("heart and life"); another reading has «চিত্ত-ঘ্রাণ» ("heart and sense of smell"). ↩
176. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *jīvātu* — life. In the edition the verse is headed: "Rādhikā's beauty and virtues are Kṛṣṇa's life and His all-in-all." ↩
177. In the edition the verse is headed: "A consideration of how Rādhikā's love for Kṛṣṇa exceeds Kṛṣṇa's love for Rādhā." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "I think My love for Rādhikā very strong, but on consideration it is the reverse: Rādhikā's love for Me is greater than Mine." ↩
178. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the sound of My flute steals Rādhikā's consciousness, and her tender song steals Mine; when Rādhikā loses consciousness she mistakes the *tamāla* tree for Kṛṣṇa, embraces it and attains great happiness. Or

else: the flute-like sound that arises when bamboos rub against each other steals her consciousness. The translation follows the second reading. ↩

179. In the edition the verse is headed: “Rādhikā is wholly absorbed in Kṛṣṇa: seeing Him everywhere, She is overwhelmed with bliss.” ↩
180. In the edition the verse is headed: “Rādhā’s happiness in serving Kṛṣṇa is unknowable even to Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
181. In the edition the verse is headed: “In the world the rasa of the lover and the beloved is equal, but in the spiritual realm the beloved’s rasa is greater.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: according to Bharata Muni the rasa of woman and man is equal; but he, though a sage, does not know the truth of My rasa of Vraja, for Rādhikā’s rasa is by its very nature greater. ↩
182. In the edition the verse is headed: “With Rādhā Kṛṣṇa’s joy is greater than with anyone.” ↩
183. *Anubhāṣya*: “lovely one” (*kalyāṇi*) — bliss embodied; “lips” — red lips whose fragrance has defeated the sweetness of nectar. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: having found you, so rich in beauty, virtues and play, My senses again and again find great delight. ↩
184. In the edition, “the words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī”. *Anubhāṣya*: *dambhodgīrṇa-mahā-dhṛtim* — “displaying great composure by pretence”; *bahir api prodyad-vikārākulām* — “even outwardly agitated by surging transformations (of *bhāva*)”; “I remember Rādhā”. ↩
185. In the edition the verse is headed: “Kṛṣṇa’s consideration of the power of His own sweetness.” ↩
186. In the edition the verse is headed: “Kṛṣṇa longs to taste Rādhā’s happiness.” ↩
187. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «আস্বাদিব» (“I shall taste”); another reading has «আস্বাদিল» (“I tasted”). In the edition the verse is headed: “Gaura descends to taste in many ways the rasa of Rādhā’s love.” ↩
188. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «শিখাইব» (“I shall teach”); another reading has «শিখাইল» (“I taught”). In the edition the verse is headed: “The preaching and practice of worship on the path of rāga.” ↩
189. In the edition the verse is headed: “Without the mood of the *āśraya*, the happiness of service cannot be tasted in the mood of the *viṣaya*.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “of another kind” (*vijātīya*) — of the kind of the *viṣaya*. ↩
190. In the edition the verse is headed: “When Kṛṣṇa descends as Gaura, the time of the *yuga-avatāra* and the call of Advaita coincide.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when Kṛṣṇa resolved to descend to fulfil His three desires and to teach the devotees the path of rāga, the time of the *yuga-avatāra* arrived, and Śrī Advaita Ācārya was worshipping Kṛṣṇa; for this reason, accepting Rādhā’s mood and

complexion, the moon Kṛṣṇa rose as Gaurāṅga from Śacī's womb in Navadvīpa. ↩

191. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «করে» (another reading: «করেন»); the sense is the same. ↩
192. In the edition verse 271 is headed: "First the elders descend, then Gaura in His own form." *Anubhāṣya*: *avatāri'* — "causing to descend". ↩
193. In the edition the verse is headed: "Meditation on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, and the citation of his verse in support." ↩
194. The same verse as 4.52 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it); the translation is the same. ↩
195. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the auspicious invocation, the characteristics of the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and the purpose of Caitanya's descent — these three subjects have been set forth in six verses. *Anubhāṣya*: "the characteristics of the truth" — that which reveals the truth of Gaura; "six verses" — from "*Vande gurūn…*" (Ādi 1.1) to "…*harīnduḥ*" (Ādi 1.6). ↩